

QUESTION 1:

Aim :

To analyze the efficiency of the Merge Sort algorithm under best, average, and worst-case scenarios using asymptotic notations.

```
def merge(left, right):
    result = []
    i = j = 0
    while i < len(left) and j < len(right):
        if left[i] <= right[j]:
            result.append(left[i])
            i += 1
        else:
            result.append(right[j])
            j += 1
    result.extend(left[i:])
    result.extend(right[j:])
    return result

def merge_sort(arr):
    if len(arr) <= 1:
        return arr
    mid = len(arr) // 2
    left = merge_sort(arr[:mid])
    right = merge_sort(arr[mid:])
    return merge(left, right)

arr = list(map(int, input("Enter numbers separated by space: ").split()))
print("Original Array:", arr)
sorted_array = merge_sort(arr)
print("Sorted Array:", sorted_array)
```

Enter numbers separated by space: 45 12 67 3 89 23
Original Array: [45, 12, 67, 3, 89, 23]
Sorted Array: [3, 12, 23, 45, 67, 89]

Analysis:

- **Best Case:**

Input Condition: The array is already sorted.

Example: 1 2 3 4 5 6

Behavior: Merge Sort still divides the array into two halves and merges them.

Complexity : $O(n \log n)$

- **Average Case**

Input Condition : Randomly ordered data.

Example : 8 2 5 1 7 3

Complexity : $O(n \log n)$

- **Worst Case**

Input Condition : Elements arranged so maximum comparisons occur during merging.

Example: 6 5 4 3 2 1

Complexity : $O(n \log n)$

Complexity Table:

Case	Input Condition	Time Complexity
Best	Already Sorted	$O(n \log n)$
Average	Random Order	$O(n \log n)$
Worst	Reverse Order	$O(n \log n)$

Space Complexity : $O(n)$

Because Merge Sort requires additional memory for merging.

Asymptotic Notation:

Notation	Meaning	Merge Sort
Big-O	Upper Bound	$O(n \log n)$
Big-Theta	Exact Bound	$\Theta(n \log n)$
Big-Omega	Lower Bound	$\Omega(n \log n)$

Comparison Chart:

Case	Complexity
Best	$O(n \log n)$
Average	$O(n \log n)$
Worst	$O(n \log n)$

Practical Relevance:

The average case is the most relevant because real-world data is usually unsorted or randomly ordered. Merge Sort consistently performs in $O(n \log n)$ regardless of the input arrangement, making it suitable for applications such as databases, search engines, and large-scale data processing.

Conclusion:

Merge Sort provides consistent performance in all cases with $\Theta(n \log n)$ time complexity. Although it requires additional memory, it is highly efficient and stable for sorting large datasets.